

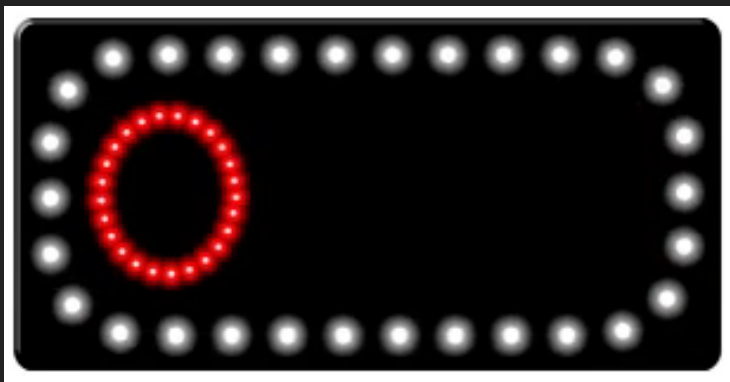
Class 7: Aspects of Social Movement Activity

Social movements and the media

AUTHOR

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Opening notes



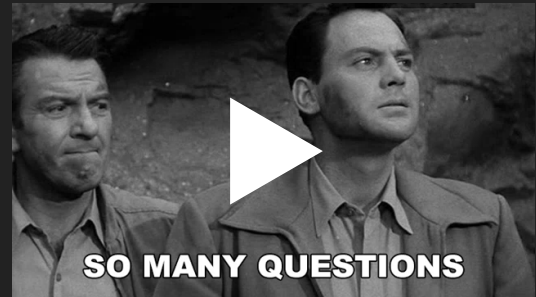
Presentation groups

Presentations line-up

Date	Presenters	Method
4 Dec:	Daichi, Seongyeon, Jehyun	TBD
18 Dec:	Ayla, Tara, Theresa, Annabelle	TBD
15 Jan:	Luna, Emilene, Raffa	TBD

Opening questions

- Where do you get your news?
- When you read the news (thinking only of 'traditional media' for the moment), what is reported, generally?



Media: the translator of social movements

What are the mechanisms of...

- movements advancing their **frames** (*Class 3*),
- **mobilisation, recruitment, participation** (*Class 4*),
- **tactics** and **strategies** achieving results (*Class 6*)?

often it is **the media** (including social media)

...

how media covers a movement is often how most people know about it

- **big practical and theoretical stakes**
- often plays a **gatekeeper** role

Past and present eras: a change of arena



The Great Barricade at the Entrance of the Rue du Faubourg St. Antoine, from the Place de la Bastille.



Past and present eras: a change of arena



The Great Barricade at the Entrance of the Rue du Faubourg St. Antoine, from the Place de la Bastille.



- previous eras: direct action, confrontation between movements and authorities more common
 - here: barricade in Paris, 1848
- modern era: indirect contention filtered through **media** more common
 - here: press pack ahead of movement press conference in Hong Kong
 - 'the whole world is watching' era
 - the **prospect** (for movements) and **peril** (for targets/authorities) now? **the whole world may be watching**

Poll: movements and media



Take the survey at <https://forms.gle/ngepuqqzaFu8nCfBA>

- ever personally supported a movement online?
 - how do media generally portray *protesters*?
 - what is most likely to help a movement get media coverage?
-
- should movements tailor their messaging/framing to gain more attention?
 - is traditional media coverage still necessary for movement success in an age of social media?
 - does social media encourage 'slacktivism'?

```
md`## Poll results (Respondents: ${respondentCount})`
```

Poll results (Respondents: 3)

```
import { liveGoogleSheet } from "@jimjamslam/live-google-sheet";
import { aq, op } from "@uwdata/arquero";

// UPDATE THE LINK FOR A NEW POLL
surveyResults = liveGoogleSheet(
  "https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/e/" +
    "2PACX-1vRFuuWCfyZQLXsybqoVeu0X8eixlnbIKG7xp_W7e9W1FRZNtLl8pMdicFnILQhxM69f1Fn4Hxf_5j"
    "pub?gid=2143204677&single=true&output=csv",
  10000, 1, 7); // adjust the last number to select all relevant columns

respondentCount = surveyResults.length;
```

how do media generally portray protesters?

```
portrayCounts = aq.from(surveyResults)
  .select("portray")
  .groupby("portray")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })

// Calculate the maximum count from your data
portray_maxCountRE = Math.max(...portrayCounts)

plot_portray = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(portrayCounts, {
      x: "portray",
      y: "count",
      fill: "portray",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke:
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "dangerous",
      "passionate",
      "misguided",
      "admirable",
      "other"
    ],
    range: [
      "goldenrod",
      "cadetblue",
      "darkorange",
      "forestgreen",
      "violet"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 400,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -
    domain: ["dangerous", "passionate", "mis
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(portrayCounts.objects().map(d
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, portray_maxCountRE]
  },
```

most likely to help a movement get media coverage?

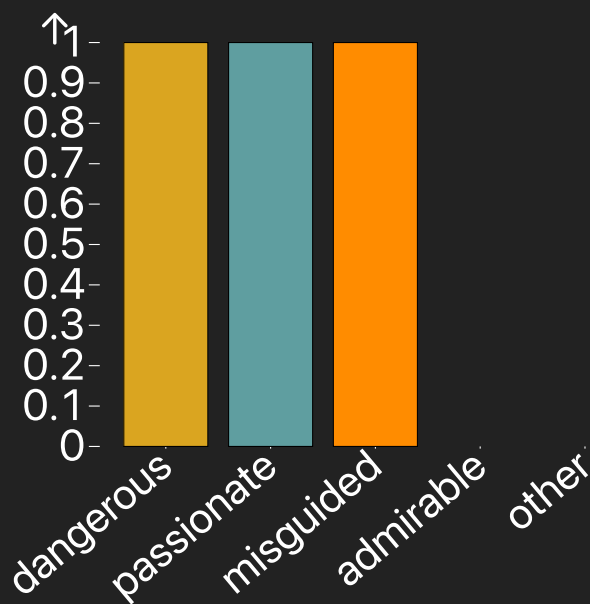
```
help_coverageCounts = aq.from(surveyResults)
  .select("help_coverage")
  .groupby("help_coverage")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })

// Calculate the maximum count from your data
help_coverage_maxCountRE = Math.max(...help_

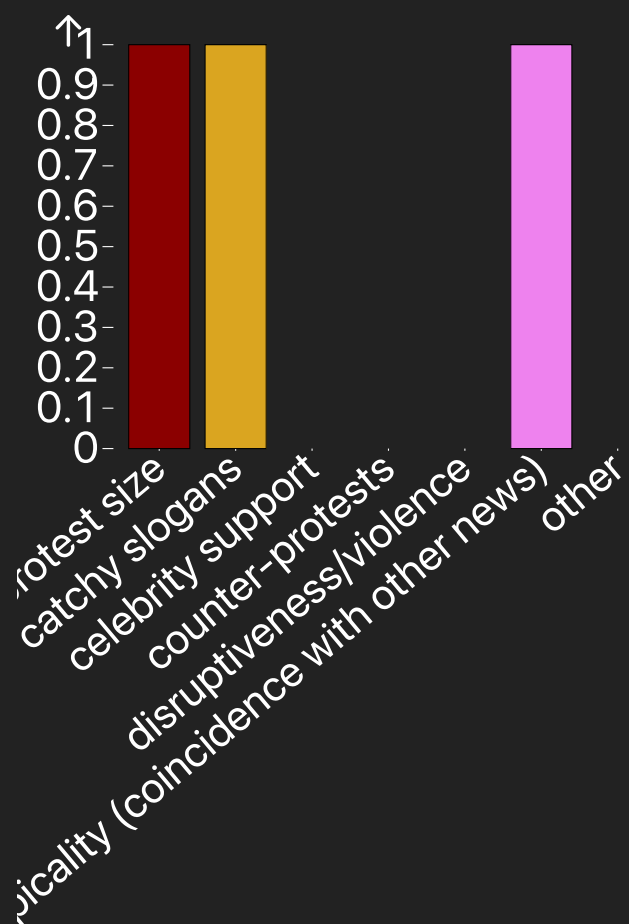
plot_help_coverage = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(help_coverageCounts, {
      x: "help_coverage",
      y: "count",
      fill: "help_coverage",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke:
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "protest size",
      "catchy slogans",
      "celebrity support",
      "counter-protests",
      "disruptiveness/violence",
      "topicality (coincidence with other ne
      "other"
    ],
    range: [
      "darkred",
      "goldenrod",
      "cadetblue",
      "darkorange",
      "forestgreen",
      "violet",
      "gray"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 400,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -
    domain: ["protest size", "catchy slogans
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
```

Poll results - boosting media coverage

```
    facet: { data: portrayCounts, x: "measure",  
marginLeft: 60,  
style: {  
width: 1600,  
height: 500,  
fontSize: 40,  
},  
});
```



```
elements: Array.from(  
new Set(help_coverageCounts.objects().  
).sort((a, b) => a - b),  
domain: [0, help_coverage_maxCountRE]  
},  
facet: { data: help_coverageCounts, x: "me  
marginLeft: 60,  
style: {  
width: 1600,  
height: 500,  
fontSize: 40,  
},  
});
```



should movements tailor their messaging/framing to gain more attention?

is traditional media coverage still necessary for movement success in an age of social media?

```
taylorCounts = aq.from(surveyResults)
  .select("taylor")
  .groupby("taylor")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })

// Calculate the maximum count from your data
taylor_maxCountRE = Math.max(...taylorCounts

plot_taylor = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(taylorCounts, {
      x: "taylor",
      y: "count",
      fill: "taylor",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke:
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "Strongly disagree",
      "Disagree",
      "Neutral",
      "Agree",
      "Strongly agree"
    ],
    range: [
      "red",
      "pink",
      "lightgrey",
      "lightgreen",
      "forestgreen"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 180,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -
    domain: ["Strongly disagree", "Disagree"
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(taylorCounts.objects().map(d =>
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, taylor_maxCountRE]
```

```
traditional_mediaCounts = aq.from(surveyResu
  .select("traditional_media")
  .groupby("traditional_media")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })

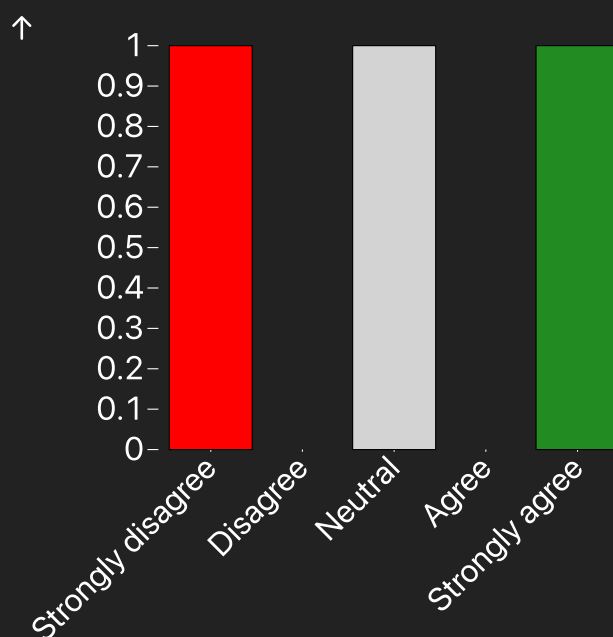
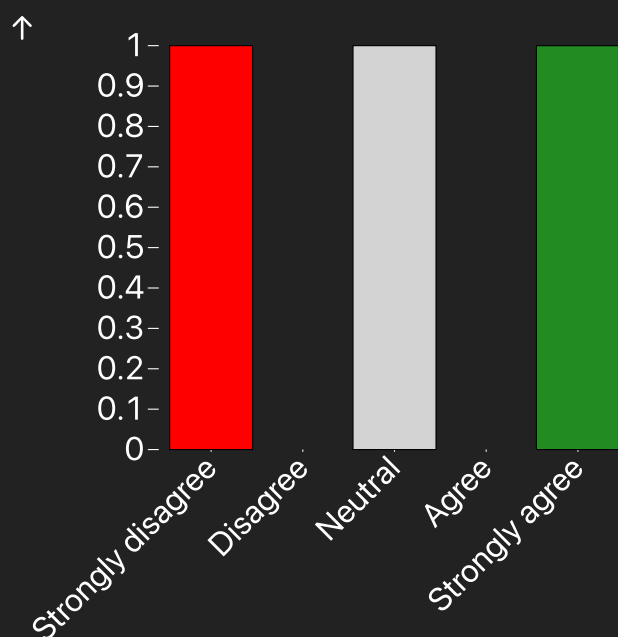
// Calculate the maximum count from your data
traditional_media_maxCountRE = Math.max(...t

plot_traditional_media = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(traditional_mediaCounts, {
      x: "traditional_media",
      y: "count",
      fill: "traditional_media",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke:
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "Strongly disagree",
      "Disagree",
      "Neutral",
      "Agree",
      "Strongly agree"
    ],
    range: [
      "red",
      "pink",
      "lightgrey",
      "lightgreen",
      "forestgreen"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 180,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -
    domain: ["Strongly disagree", "Disagree"
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(traditional_mediaCounts.object
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, traditional_media_maxCountRE]
```

Poll results - online

```
    domain: [0, tailor_maxCountRE]
  },
  facet: { data: tailorCounts, x: "measure",
marginLeft: 140,
  style: {
    width: 1350,
    height: 500,
    fontSize: 30,
  }
});
```

```
    domain: [0, traditional_media_maxCountRE]
  },
  facet: { data: traditional_mediaCounts, x:
marginLeft: 140,
  style: {
    width: 1350,
    height: 500,
    fontSize: 30,
  }
});
```



ever personally supported a movement online?

does social media encourage 'slacktivism'?

```
personally_sharedCounts = aq.from(surveyResu
  .select("personally_shared")
  .groupby("personally_shared")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })
```

```
// Calculate the maximum count from your dat
personally_shared_maxCountRE = Math.max(...p
```

```
plot_personally_shared = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(personally_sharedCounts, {
      x: "personally_shared",
      y: "count",
      fill: "personally_shared",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke:
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "Yes",
      "No",
      "Maybe"
    ],
    range: [
      "forestgreen",
      "darkred",
      "goldenrod"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 80,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -
    domain: ["Yes", "No", "Maybe"]
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(personally_sharedCounts.object
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, personally_shared_maxCountRE
  ],
  facet: { data: personally_sharedCounts, x:
  marginLeft: 60,
  style: {
    width: 1600.
```

```
slacktivismCounts = aq.from(surveyResults)
  .select("slacktivism")
  .groupby("slacktivism")
  .count()
  .derive({ measure: d => "" })
```

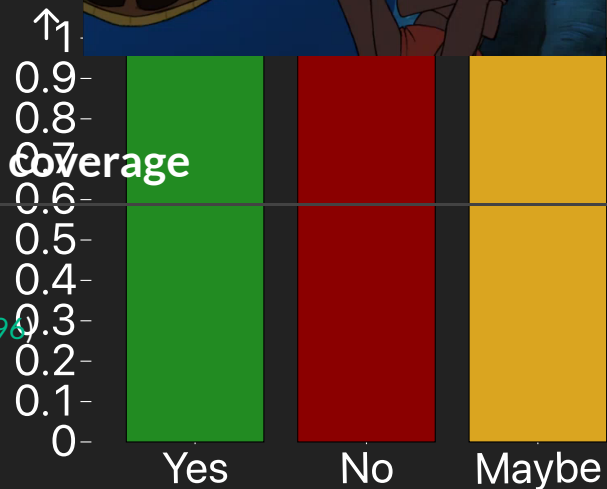
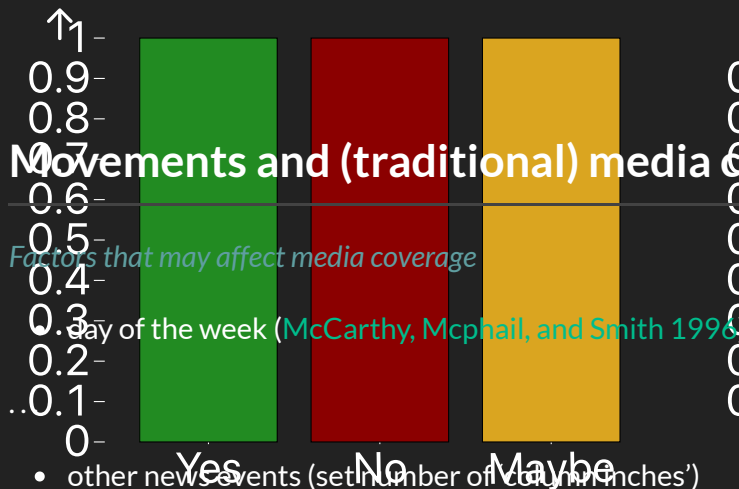
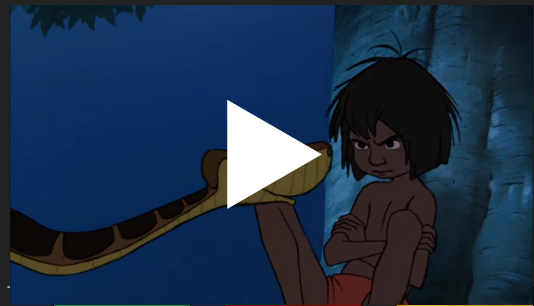
```
// Calculate the maximum count from your dat
slacktivism_maxCountRE = Math.max(...slackti
```

```
plot_slacktivism = Plot.plot({
  marks: [
    Plot.barY(slacktivismCounts, {
      x: "slacktivism",
      y: "count",
      fill: "slacktivism",
      stroke: "black",
      strokeWidth: 1
    }),
    Plot.ruleY([respondentCount], { stroke:
  ],
  color: {
    domain: [
      "Yes",
      "No",
      "Maybe"
    ],
    range: [
      "forestgreen",
      "darkred",
      "goldenrod"
    ]
  },
  marginBottom: 80,
  x: { label: "", tickSize: 2, tickRotate: -
    domain: ["Yes", "No", "Maybe"]
  },
  y: {
    label: "",
    tickSize: 10,
    tickFormat: d => d,
    tickValues: Array.from(
      new Set(slacktivismCounts.objects().ma
    ).sort((a, b) => a - b),
    domain: [0, slacktivism_maxCountRE]
  },
  facet: { data: slacktivismCounts, x: "meas
  marginLeft: 60,
  style: {
    width: 1600.
```

Movements and (traditional) media coverage

- (some) factors influencing media coverage

- Jennings and Saunders (2019)
 - research questions, importance
 - data and methods
 - hypotheses
 - results



- weather (Madestam et al. 2013)

- celebrities (Atkinson and DeWitt 2018)

- size of event, violence/disruptiveness, whether there is a counterdemonstration (Denardo 1985; McCarthy, Mcphail, and Smith 1996; Biggs 2018)

Movements and (traditional) media coverage

Factors that may affect media coverage

- size of event, violence/disruptiveness, whether there is a counterdemonstration (Denardo 1985; McCarthy, Mcphail, and Smith 1996; Biggs 2018)
 - larger protests get reported – duh!
 - media attention cycles (topicality) (McCarthy et al. 1996)
 - if Germany's energy is in the news, then energy/climate protests may get more attention
 - counterdemonstrations may help attract more attention (media bias for 'both sides')

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - RQs

- Why do some protests get reported on and others not?
- What protests get covered over the long term and why?

...

- Why? What's at stake?
 - **demonstrations** are **effective** when they not only hit newspaper headlines, but create a "**sustained shift in media focus, onto the issues that the demonstration raises**" (p. 2287)

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - data and methods

- **48 street demonstrations in nine countries between 2009 - 2013**
 - **surveys** – how do you think this is done?
 - Belgium, Czechia, Denmark, Germany, Netherlands, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, and United Kingdom
 - any important contextual considerations?

...

The design of our study is **large-N** (based on a sample of demonstrations, avoiding the tautology endemic to many studies of media attention to protest, which **select cases based on their being reported in the media**), at the same time as putting protest in context. (pp. 2293-4)

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - data and methods

- **48 street demonstrations in nine countries between 2009 - 2013**
 - **surveys** – how do you think this is done?
 - Belgium, Czechia, Denmark, Germany, Netherlands, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, and United Kingdom
- **DV**: level of national media attention to related issue *over time*
- **IVs**:
 - number of participants
 - presence of counterdemo
 - extent of violence
 - presence of trigger event
 - any '**omitted variables**' problems

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - hypotheses

```
library(kableExtra)
library(dplyr)
```

Attaching package: 'dplyr'

The following object is masked from 'package:kableExtra':

group_rows

The following objects are masked from 'package:stats':

filter, lag

The following objects are masked from 'package:base':

intersect, setdiff, setequal, union

```
table_data <- data.frame(
  Feature = c("Number of participants", "Contentiousness", "Exhibit violence", "Trigger e
  Static = c("larger = more coverage", "high = more coverage", "violence = more coverage"
  Dynamic = c("short- and long-term coverage", "short- and long-term coverage", "short-te
)

# Generate the kable table
kable(table_data, col.names = c("Feature", "Static", "Dynamic")) %>%
  kable_styling(latex_options = c("striped", "hold_position"))
```

Feature	Static	Dynamic
Number of participants	larger = more coverage	short- and long-term coverage
Contentiousness	high = more coverage	short- and long-term coverage
Exhibit violence	violence = more coverage	short-term coverage, long-term losses/costs
Trigger event	trigger = more coverage	short-term coverage

do these expectations make sense to you? do you disagree with any?

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - reg table

Table 3. Dynamic Model of Contextual Predictors on Media Coverage of Protest Issues.

	MEDIA _{it}	
PULSE _{it}	16.73 (13.46)	7.25 (7.34)
STEP _{it}	73.08 (21.74)**	54.74 (11.03)**
RAMP _{it}	-21.91 (6.82)**	-13.65 (3.68)**
TONE _i	10.01 (10.77)	15.41 (13.94)
SIZE _i	2.26 (5.29)	-0.18 (4.16)
COUNTER _i	65.55 (10.75)**	72.25 (18.10)**
DEMPOL _i	27.28 (6.85)**	26.37 (7.81)**
TRIGGER _i	-7.00 (20.08)	-3.99 (23.29)
SIZE _i × PULSE _{it}		23.74 (7.44)**
SIZE _i × STEP _{it}		46.87 (11.41)**
SIZE _i × RAMP _{it}		-15.14 (3.64)**
COUNTER _i × PULSE _{it}		-22.00 (21.89)
COUNTER _i × STEP _{it}		-75.41 (35.55)*
COUNTER _i × RAMP _{it}		26.93 (10.54)*
DEMPOL _i × PULSE _{it}		13.67 (5.99)*
DEMPOL _i × STEP _{it}		-23.72 (9.25)*
DEMPOL _i × RAMP _{it}		8.66 (3.05)**
TRIGGER _i × PULSE _{it}		19.75 (22.22)

$$\text{TRIGGER}_i \times \text{STEP}_{it}$$

(23.20)

55.83

(38.03)

Remember: regression is a tool for understanding a phenomenon as a linear function (generally) $\rightarrow (y = mx + b)$

1. Numbers not in parentheses next to a variable: **regression coefficient**: expected change in DV for a one-unit increase in IV. NB: ositive or negative relationship?
2. Numbers inside parentheses next to a variable: **standard error**: estimate of the standard deviation of the coefficient
3. Asterisks/'stars': **statistical significance**: probability of results as extreme as observed result, under the assumption that the null hypothesis is correct. Smaller p-value means such an observation would be less likely under null hypothesis; hence, significance. Statistical significance suggests more precise estimates—NOT necessarily that one IV is more important than another.

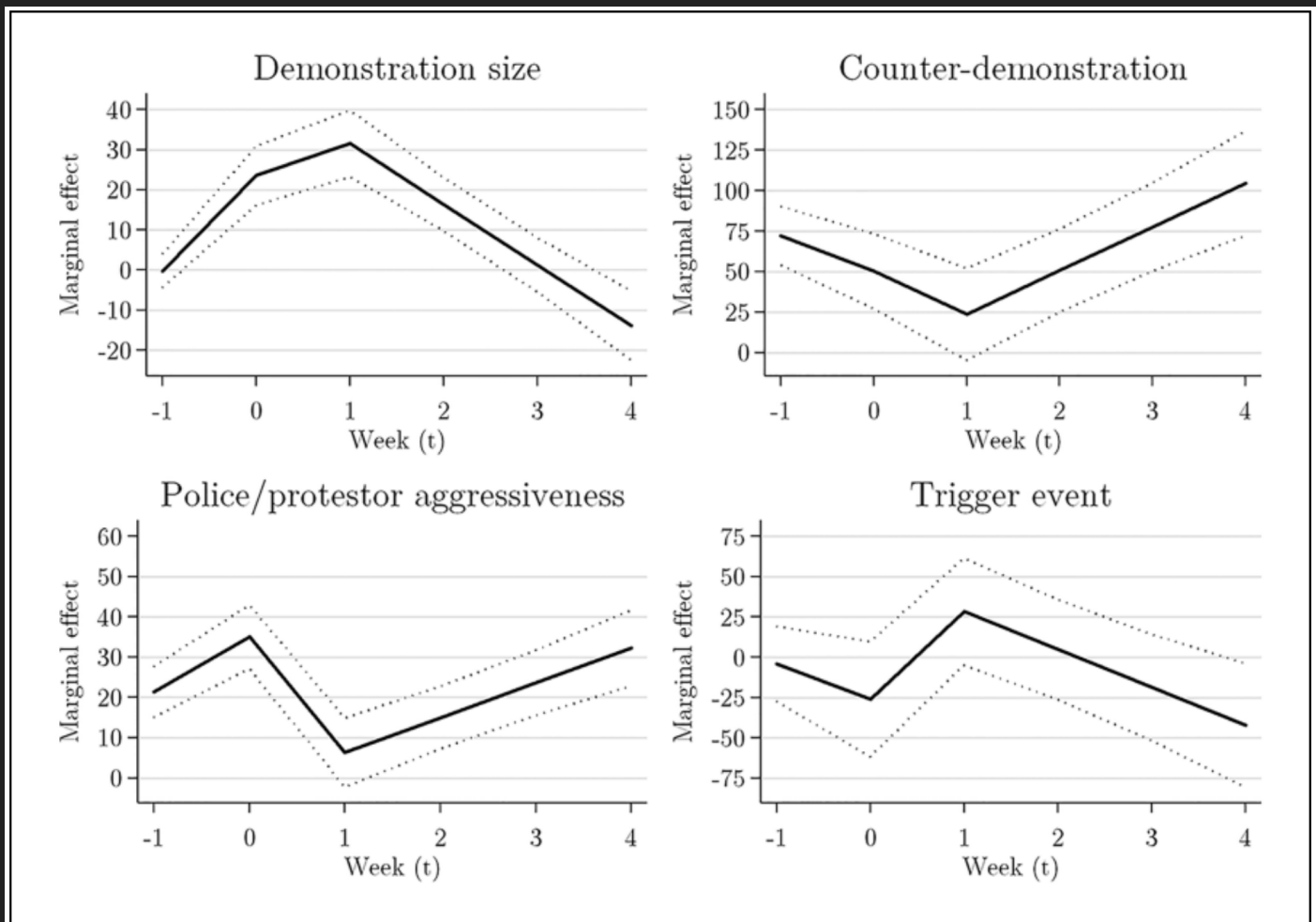
Jennings and Saunders (2019) - reg table

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TRIGGER _i	-7.00 (20.08)	-3.99 (23.29)
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DEMPOL _i × RAMP _{it}		8.66 (3.05)**
TRIGGER _i × PULSE _{it}		19.75 (23.20)
TRIGGER _i × STEP _{it}		55.83 (38.03)

- Numbers not in parentheses next to a variable: **regression coefficient**: expected change in DV for a one-unit increase in IV.
- Numbers inside parentheses next to a variable: **standard error**: estimate of the standard deviation of the coefficient
- Asterisks/'stars': **statistical significance**: probability of results as extreme as observed result, under the assumption that the null hypothesis is correct. Smaller p-value means such an observation would be less likely under null hypothesis; hence, significance. Statistical significance suggests more precise estimates.

Jennings and Saunders (2019) - marginal effects

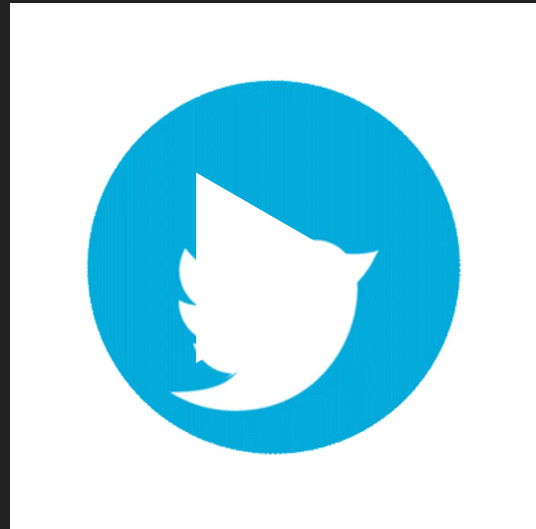


Jennings and Saunders (2019) - conclusions

- **demos increase media coverage**, but **effect decays quickly**
 - practical importance? **'strike while the iron is hot'**
- **large size and police aggressiveness increase media coverage**
- **counterdemos significantly reduced media coverage of protest issues in longer term**
 - puzzling finding

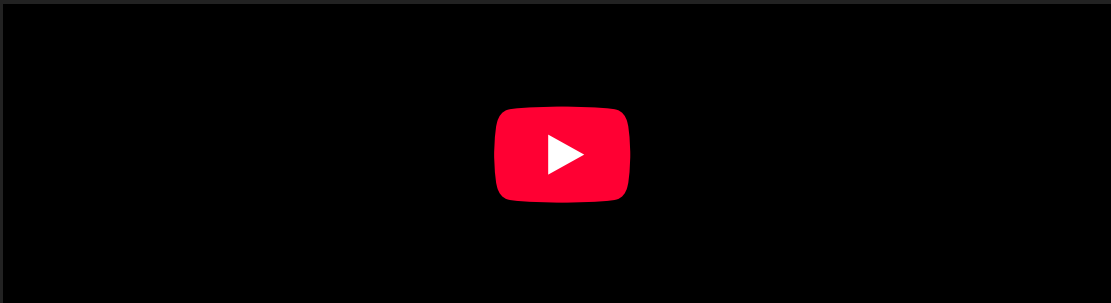
Social movements and social media

- from #hashtag to mobilisation
 - BLM example
- Slacktivism



From #hashtag to mobilisation

(USA Today on BLM)



From #hashtag to mobilisation

(USA Today on BLM)

social media breaks down traditional media **gatekeeper** roles

- helped BLM form **coalition** of K-Pop fans, Anonymous, celebrities, etc.
- enhanced BLM's 'narrative capacity' (i.e., efficacy in advancing **frames**, shifting status quo)
 - cf. 'disruptive capacity' and 'institutional/political capacity'

Movements and social media - revisiting a debate

Class 4: we listened to Tufekci and social media mobilisation and 'old-school organisation' - can attract more participants, but perhaps with less commitment

- “Slacktivism” & network structure of protest media coverage



Movements, media, and astroturfing

- Torches of Freedom
- astroturfing
- knock-on effects



Torches of Freedom

1929, Easter Sunday Parade: a Tabubruch? more emancipation for women?



Movements, media, and astroturfing

astroturfing - manipulation of public sphere (media, information, movement scene)

- fake 'grassroots movements' are a common form of astroturfing
 - a way of harnessing the 'power of movement'
 - e.g., 'Tea Party movement' - a 'people's' movement funded by Koch Industries
- **any examples, instances of this in/around your case?**

Torches of Freedom

- **Edward Bernays** ('father of PR')
- working for American Tobacco Company from 1927
 - 'smoke instead of eating'/thinness advertising
 - medical experts enlisted to promote smoking over eating sweets
- Easter Day Parade, 1929
 - Bernays paid **feminist movement** members to smoke on the parade
 - 'while [the women] should be good looking, they should not look too model-y'
- **1923**: women accounted for **5 per cent** of cigarette sales; **1929**: **12 per cent**; **1935**: **18 per cent**



Astroturfing: knock-on effects

- when movements are sometimes faked/manufactured, it undermines potential credibility of other movements
 - are people being 'paid to protest'? who is 'behind' this protest?
 - questioning motives/genuineness of movements
 - **Letzte Generation**: funding from Climate Emergency Fund (U.S.), including Aileen Getty, heir of Getty Oil company

- **Just Stop Oil (U.K.):** large amounts of funding from Climate Emergency Fund, from Dale Vince (green energy industrialist)
- examples of conspiracy beliefs in U.S. (George Soros, Sandy Hook, etc.)

see further, on the theory: Herman, E. S., & Chomsky, N. (1988). *Manufacturing consent: The political economy of the mass media*. Random House.

Any questions, concerns, feedback for this class?

Anonymous feedback here: <https://forms.gle/AjHt6fcnwZxkSg4X8>

Alternatively, please send me an email: m.zeller@lmu.de

References

- Atkinson, Matthew D., and Darin DeWitt. 2018. "Does Celebrity Issue Advocacy Mobilize Issue Publics?" *Political Studies*, no. 2. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0032321717751294>.
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